of writing a book, but I came to appreciate the bonds of friendship it allows him to form. He is rarely happier than when he spends a day in the fields with Henry Bright, his great countryside companion.

Though our respective schedules ensured that around half of our interviews were conducted over the course of a week in the United Arab Emirates, Alastair lives no more than a couple of miles from me. Sheep from his family farm graze in the village, and he is a familiar figure at local events. We might do different jobs, but we would not be able to do so without the support of our families.

Thank you, above all, to Alice and Lynn, our respective wives, for putting up with us.

Michael Calvin, July 2019